LEADERSHIP INQUIRY

How do we constrain Copilot?

Use these four control surfaces to explain what is constrained, where it applies, and how strongly it is enforced.

Leadership takeaway

Bring back three things: the constraints currently in place, the scope where each applies, and the constraints you recommend based on risk, compliance, and how teams actually work.

Control	Where to find it	What it tells you
Agent governance + rulesets	Enterprise > AI controls > Agents; repository rulesets	Controls which agent configurations are available and preserves repository protections. Branch rulesets and required checks still apply to Copilot cloud agent activity.
Custom instructions + content exclusions	Organization Settings > Copilot > Custom instructions; Content exclusion	Instructions guide how Copilot should respond. Content exclusions keep configured repositories or paths out of supported Copilot experiences. Instructions are guidance, not a guaranteed hard enforcement boundary.
Cloud agent + automations	Organization Settings > Copilot > Cloud agent	Shows which repositories the coding agent can work in and whether automations are allowed. Enterprise policy can restrict what an organization can change.
Internet access	Organization Settings > Copilot > Internet access	Shows outbound network exposure: firewall state, repository custom rules, organization allowlists, and allowed domains/URLs. Organization policy can lock repository-level choices.

How to answer Leadership

- Start with the control: what is enabled, disabled, excluded, or required.
- State its scope: enterprise, organization, repository, agent, or supported Copilot surface.
- Separate guidance from enforcement: custom instructions influence behavior; policies, rulesets, access, exclusions, and network controls are stronger boundaries.
- End with a recommendation tied to a real requirement: risk, compliance, data exposure, or team workflow.

Official GitHub references

Prepare for custom agents
Organization custom instructions
Cloud agent for organizations
Copilot policies
Content exclusion
Customize the firewall

FINANCE INQUIRY

Where is Copilot spend coming from?

Answer Finance in four passes: amount, ownership, budgets, then what happens when included usage is exhausted.

Finance takeaway

Report the billable amount for the organization, who owns the cost, every budget or hard stop that applies, and whether additional usage is blocked or becomes paid usage.

1 Check organization spend

- Enterprise account > Billing & Licensing > Overview > Usage by organization > View all organization usage > add 'org:YOURORGNAME' in the filter
- Select the organization and use the current billing period. If GitHub shows both gross and billable amounts, report both and use the billable amount as the direct Finance answer.

2 Map the cost to an owner

- Enterprise account > Billing & Licensing > Cost centers. Find the cost center associated with the organization.
- Review assigned organizations, repositories, users, and enterprise teams. If no cost center applies, treat the cost as Enterprise Only.

3 Review every applicable budget

- Open Budgets and alerts. Check enterprise, organization, cost-center, product, SKU, and user-level budgets that apply.
- For each applicable budget, review scope, monthly amount, current consumption, alert recipients, and whether usage stops at the limit.
- Budgets can overlap. A more restrictive applicable hard stop can block usage before another budget is exhausted.

4 Confirm included vs. paid usage behavior

- Open the relevant cost center and review its included-usage control, if configured.
- Confirm whether reaching the included-credit limit blocks users or allows paid usage, then check the paid-usage policy and any user-level budget that also applies.

Finance-ready answer

For the current billing period: state the organization’s billable amount (and gross amount if shown), identify the cost center or Enterprise Only owner, list the budgets/limits that apply, and explain whether reaching included usage stops consumption or moves it into paid usage.

Fast check before you leave the billing view

Answer	Control surface	Evidence to bring back
Amount	Billing overview	Current period billable amount; gross amount if shown
Owner	Cost centers	Business/financial owner receiving the mapped costs
Limits	Budgets and alerts	Applicable budget scopes, consumption, alerts, and hard stops
Overage behavior	Included + paid usage controls	Blocked at the limit vs. paid usage permitted

SECURITY INQUIRY

How are policies and access managed?

Separate the answer into who has access, what policies are enforced, and what the audit trail shows changed.

Security takeaway
Security should be able to see who can use Copilot, which controls apply or are inherited, and who changed access or policy settings and when.

1 Review access

- Organization > Settings > Copilot > Access. Use Filter to review available access views and Get usage report to see the reports available to admins.
- Open the Copilot plan status control and verify whether access is Disabled, All members, or Selected members.
- When All members is selected, the access-management list below is not what determines inclusion; all organization members receive access.

2 Review policy controls and inheritance

- Organization > Settings > Copilot > Policies. Review Features, Clients, Agents, MCP, and any preview/other controls relevant to your environment.
- Pay attention to inherited settings so you can distinguish enterprise-enforced controls from settings the organization can manage itself.

3 Verify changes in the audit log

- Organization > Settings > Logs (under Archive) > Audit log. Set an explicit review period first, for example: created:2026-07-01..2026-09-21.

Audit search	What it answers	What to record
action:copilot	Copilot policy and settings changes	Who changed Copilot configuration and when
action:business	Enterprise administrator changes	Enterprise admin/role changes
action:org	Organization administrator changes	Organization admin/role changes
action:copilot.cfb_seat_assignment_created	New Copilot seat grants	Actor, affected user, timestamp
action:copilot.cfb_seat_cancelled	Copilot seat removals	Actor, affected user, timestamp
action:team	Team membership changes	Membership changes that can drive seat assignment

Security-ready answer
State the current access mode, the key Copilot policies and who enforces them, then cite the audit event showing who changed a policy, admin role, seat assignment, or team membership and when.

Three actions to take back

Area	Recommended follow-up
CONSTRAINTS	Review one guardrail whose scope or enforcement is unclear, then confirm where it applies.
SPEND	Validate cost ownership for one organization and confirm the budgets/hard stops that can affect paid usage.
CONTROL	Validate one policy or access setting and confirm its owner, inheritance, and audit trail.

Note: Menu labels and available controls can vary by plan, role, enterprise policy, and feature availability. Leadership control descriptions are linked to official GitHub Docs; Finance and Security flows follow the workshop demo speaker notes.